

24 Apr 2026 06:29:21 ET | 16 pages

Intel Corp (INTC.O)

AI CPU Cycle + Terafab Foundry Opportunity = U/G to Buy

CITI'S TAKE

We upgrade Intel to Buy from Neutral on improving agentic AI driven CPU demand which should lift all the CPU suppliers' sales in the coming years. Moreover, execution on 18A/14A manufacturing yields is tracking better than expectations, and Intel should be a major beneficiary of Elon Musk initiative to support Terafab, in our view. While we acknowledge Intel stock is up 19% after market on "beat and raise" results, our new detailed SOTP analysis shows fair value of \$95 which offers ~20% further upside. We believe Terafab announcement lends credence to Intel building a successful foundry business under the leadership of Lip Bu who has right sized the company and is showing steady execution.

Server CPU TAM — Intel now expects double digit server CPU unit growth in 2026, up from their prior expectations of only slight growth six months ago, with unit growth being the primary driver and ASPs benefiting from higher core counts. Intel expects this growth to sustain in 2027.

Expects foundry operating breakeven exiting 2027 — Intel expects formal customer announcements and design commitments to begin emerging in 2H26/1H27. Intel expects to get to operating profit breakeven exiting 2027, though the timeline could push out if they get their first large foundry customer due to incremental expenses to support that customer.

Capex. Intel now expects 2026 capex to be flat YoY, up from prior expectations of flat to down YoY, with tool spending up ~25% YoY offset by materially lower spend on fab space. Management could adjust capex as external foundry commitments firm. The first tranche of 14A customers will be supported out of Arizona. Intel is growing capacity across all nodes, and it will be a while before Intel has to spend on the shell space for Ohio.

PC CPU TAM — Intel expects the PC CPU TAM to be down low double digits YoY in 2026. While industry PC units are forecasted to decline to low double digits in 2026, Intel expects flattish client revenue beyond Q2, due to price increases and inventory replenishment. AI PCs account for more than 60% of client mix.

EPS (US\$)	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	FY	FC Cons	VA Cons
2025A	-0.02A	-0.25A	0.10A	0.05A	-0.12A	0.42A	0.42A
2026E	0.17A	0.12E	0.13E	0.21E	0.63E	0.55E	0.57E
Previous	-0.12E	-0.08E	-0.01E	0.11E	-0.10E	na	na
2027E	0.15E	0.23E	0.38E	0.47E	1.24E	1.12E	1.12E
Previous	0.06E	0.15E	0.26E	0.33E	0.81E	na	na
2028E	0.39E	0.49E	0.57E	0.66E	2.11E	1.70E	1.70E
Previous	0.20E	0.23E	0.27E	0.33E	1.02E	na	na

Source: Company Reports and dataCentral, Citi Research. FC Cons: First Call Consensus. VA Cons: Visible Alpha Consensus.

Click [here](#) for Visible Alpha consensus data

Buy ↑ from Neutral

Price (23 Apr 26 16:00) US\$66.78

Target price US\$95.00↑
from US\$48.00

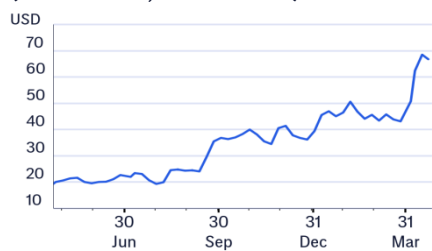
Expected share price return 42.3%

Expected dividend yield 0.0%

Expected total return 42.3%

Market Cap US\$335,303M

Price Performance (RIC: INTC.O, BB: INTC US)



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See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations.

INTC.O: Fiscal year end 31-Dec						Price: US\$66.78; TP: US\$95.00; Market Cap: US\$335,303m; Recomm: Buy					
Profit & Loss (US\$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	Valuation ratios	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Sales revenue	53,101	52,853	57,477	63,100	71,500	PE (x)	-71.9	na	na	53.8	31.6
Cost of sales	-34,877	-34,062	-34,427	-34,586	-34,944	PB (x)	2.6	2.3	2.5	2.2	2.0
Gross profit	18,224	18,791	23,050	28,514	36,556	EV/EBITDA (x)	46.1	28.5	19.8	15.4	11.7
Gross Margin (%)	34.3	35.6	40.1	45.2	51.1	FCF yield (%)	-0.2	-1.9	2.2	0.2	-0.4
EBITDA (Adj)	7,715	12,188	16,845	21,206	27,676	Dividend yield (%)	0.6	na	na	na	na
EBITDA Margin (Adj) (%)	14.5	23.1	29.3	33.6	38.7	Payout ratio (%)	-40	0	0	0	0
Depreciation	-9,951	-10,757	-11,273	-11,753	-13,037	ROE (%)	-3.8	-0.4	2.5	4.5	6.8
Amortisation	-1,428	-949	-967	-966	-964	Cashflow (US\$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
EBIT (Adj)	-3,664	482	4,605	8,488	13,676	EBITDA	7,550	12,099	16,828	21,206	27,676
EBIT Margin (Adj) (%)	-6.9	0.9	8.0	13.5	19.1	Working capital	1,103	-1,747	-1,487	-202	-806
Net interest	0	0	0	0	0	Other	14,811	-790	7,365	1,582	1,005
Associates	0	0	0	0	0	Operating cashflow	23,464	9,562	22,706	22,586	27,875
Non-Op/Except/Other Adj	70	-274	340	40	40	Capex	-23,944	-14,646	-15,145	-21,788	-29,156
Pre-tax profit	-3,594	208	4,945	8,528	13,716	Net acq/disposals	0	0	0	0	0
Tax	-463	-317	-638	-1,023	-1,646	Other	-736	352	-40	0	0
Extraord./Min.Int./Pref.div.	0	-396	-1,079	-1,100	-1,100	Investing cashflow	-24,680	-14,294	-15,185	-21,788	-29,156
Reported net profit	-4,057	-505	3,228	6,404	10,970	Dividends paid	-1,599	0	0	0	0
Net Margin (%)	-7.6	-1.0	5.6	10.1	15.3	Financing cashflow	-556	-2,979	-3,971	-1,078	-1,093
Core NPAT	-4,057	-505	3,228	6,404	10,970	Net change in cash	-1,772	-7,711	3,551	-280	-2,375
Per share data	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	Free cashflow to s/holders	-480	-5,084	7,561	798	-1,282
Reported EPS (\$)	-0.98	-0.12	0.63	1.24	2.11						
Core EPS (\$)	-0.93	-0.12	0.63	1.24	2.11						
DPS (\$)	0.38	0	0	0	0						
CFPS (\$)	5.37	2.36	4.43	4.38	5.37						
FCFPS (\$)	-0.11	-1.26	1.48	0.15	-0.25						
BVPS (\$)	25.35	28.79	27.22	29.87	33.80						
Wtd avg ord shares (m)	4,144	4,389	4,985	5,020	5,051						
Wtd avg diluted shares (m)	4,370	4,044	5,122	5,160	5,190						
Growth rates	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E						
Sales revenue (%)	-2.1	-0.5	8.7	9.8	13.3						
EBIT (Adj) (%)	-354.8	113.2	855.4	84.3	61.1						
Core NPAT (%)	-426.1	87.6	739.2	98.4	71.3						
Core EPS (%)	-430.6	86.5	604.7	96.9	70.3						
Balance Sheet (US\$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E						
Cash & cash equiv.	22,062	37,416	42,344	46,411	50,225						
Accounts receivables	3,478	3,839	4,164	4,514	5,173						
Inventory	12,198	11,618	12,456	11,817	12,492						
Net fixed & other tangibles	107,919	105,414	107,595	117,630	133,750						
Goodwill & intangibles	35,859	33,815	30,236	30,236	30,236						
Financial & other assets	14,969	19,327	21,357	21,357	21,357						
Total assets	196,485	211,429	218,153	231,965	253,233						
Accounts payable	12,556	9,882	9,298	8,807	9,335						
Short-term debt	3,729	2,499	2,004	2,004	2,004						
Long-term debt	46,282	44,086	43,027	43,027	43,027						
Provisions & other liab	28,886	28,602	28,153	28,153	28,153						
Total liabilities	91,453	85,069	82,482	81,991	82,519						
Shareholders' equity	105,032	126,360	135,670	149,974	170,715						
Minority interests	0	0	0	0	0						
Total equity	105,032	126,360	135,670	149,974	170,715						
Net debt (Adj)	27,949	9,169	2,687	-1,380	-5,194						
Net debt to equity (Adj) (%)	26.6	7.3	2.0	-0.9	-3.0						

For definitions of the items in this table, please click [here](#).

Upgrade Intel to Buy w/\$95 TP

Advanced packaging opportunity in the billions. Intel expects advanced packaging demand scaling to billions of dollars annually, up from prior expectations of only hundreds of millions. Management expects foundry average margins over time.

ASICs now a \$1B+ run rate business. Intel's ASIC business (e.g.: Google Mount Evans) is now running at north of \$1bn in annualized revenue with multiple customers. Current revenue is primarily from networking ASICs, but Intel intends to extend to compute and accelerator ASICs over time.

Terafab. Elon Musk and Lip-Bu fundamentally agree that the semiconductor supply chain is not keeping up with silicon demand, and both believe there must be US-based silicon innovation.

Seasonality comment was on a half-on-half basis. Based on prior seasonality, Intel expects 48% sales in 1H26 and 52% of sales in 2H26. Improvement in 2H26 will likely be largely driven by supply improvements with servers above and PCs below prior seasonality.

Supply constraints. Intel is less exposed to Helium supply shortage compared to peers due to their diversified manufacturing base. Memory continues to be the tightest component.

Modeling. Sequential decline in 2Q gross margins is primarily due to 18A ramp, and higher inventory charges benefited in 1Q26 but isn't expected to continue. 1Q is not the new base for interest expense as Intel had non-recurring 5-6 cents of EPS from charges in 1Q. 2Q interest expense will be the new baseline for the rest of the year. NCI of \$250 million per quarter is dilutive.

Figure 1. INTC P&L Changes*

	Old	New		Old	New	
FY end: December	1Q26E	1Q26E	Delta	2Q26E	2Q26E	Delta
Total Revenue	12,200.0	13,577.0	11%	12,800.0	14,300.0	12%
% Change Y/Y	-3.7%	7.2%		-0.5%	11.2%	
% Change Q/Q	-10.8%	-0.7%		4.9%	5.3%	
Gross Margins	33.1%	40.1%	699 bps	34.0%	38.2%	420 bps
SG&A	1,189.5	1,038.0	-12.7%	1,248.0	1,072.5	-14.1%
% Total Revenue	9.8%	7.6%	-21.6%	9.8%	7.5%	-23.1%
R&D	3,172.0	3,375.0	6.4%	3,200.0	3,432.0	7.3%
% Total Revenue	26.0%	24.9%	-4.4%	25.0%	24.0%	-4.0%
Operating Margins %	-2.7%	7.7%	1036 bps	-0.8%	6.7%	745 bps
Other Income (Expense)	(10)	370	-3800%	(10)	(10)	0%
Pretax Income	(333)	1,417	-525%	(106)	948	-994%
% Total Revenue	-2.7%	10.4%	-482%	-0.8%	6.6%	-901%
Tax Rate	11.0%	15.8%	44%	13.0%	11.0%	-15%
Net Income attributable to Intel	(622)	864	-239%	(392)	594	-251%
Diluted Shares	5,100	5,083	0%	5,125	5,125	0%
Proforma EPS No options	\$0.00	\$0.29	292050%	\$0.04	\$0.24	464%
% Change Y/Y	-103.5%	118.8%		-142.1%	-337.2%	
% Change Q/Q	-102.9%	85.0%		-1016.7%	-18.0%	

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Source: Citi Research

*Note dataCentral estimates include options

Figure 2. INTC 2026 and 2027 P&L Changes*

	Old	New		Old	New	
FY end: December	2026E	2026E	Delta	2027E	2027E	Delta
Total Revenue	53,600.0	57,477.0	7%	56,900.0	63,100.0	11%
% Change Y/Y	1.4%	8.7%		6.2%	9.8%	
% Change Q/Q						
Gross Margins	36.0%	40.1%	415 bps	43.9%	45.2%	128 bps
SG&A	5,154.5	4,478.5	-13.1%	5,187.5	5,048.0	-2.7%
% Total Revenue	9.6%	7.8%	-19.0%	9.1%	8.0%	-12.3%
R&D	13,306.0	13,983.0	5.1%	13,508.0	14,978.5	10.9%
% Total Revenue	24.8%	24.3%	-2.0%	23.7%	23.7%	0.0%
Operating Margins %	1.5%	8.0%	650 bps	11.1%	13.5%	240 bps
Other Income (Expense)	(40)	340	-950%	40	40	0%
Pretax Income	770	4,945	542%	6,330	8,528	35%
% Total Revenue	1.4%	8.6%	499%	11.1%	13.5%	21%
Tax Rate	13.9%	12.9%	-7%	13.0%	12.0%	-8%
Net Income attributable to Intel	663	4,307	550%	5,507	7,504	36%
Diluted Shares	5,068	5,122	1%	5,160	5,160	0%
Proforma EPS No options	\$0.37	\$1.12	201%	\$1.28	\$1.74	35%
% Change Y/Y	-10.2%	169.9%		243.6%	54.7%	
% Change Q/Q						

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Source: Citi Research

*Note dataCentral estimates include options

Figure 3. SOTP Valuation Analysis

Revenue	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	P/E
CCG	\$46	-\$18	\$27	\$29	\$32	15
DCAI	\$10	-\$12	\$36	\$44	\$49	27
Intel Foundry	\$0	\$0	-\$3	-\$1	\$11	20
All Other (Mobileye/IMS)	\$0	\$0	\$1	\$1	\$1	15
Net Cash Per Share	-\$6	-\$2	-\$1	\$0	\$1	
Total					\$95	

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Source: Citi Research, FactSet, *EPS excludes SBC

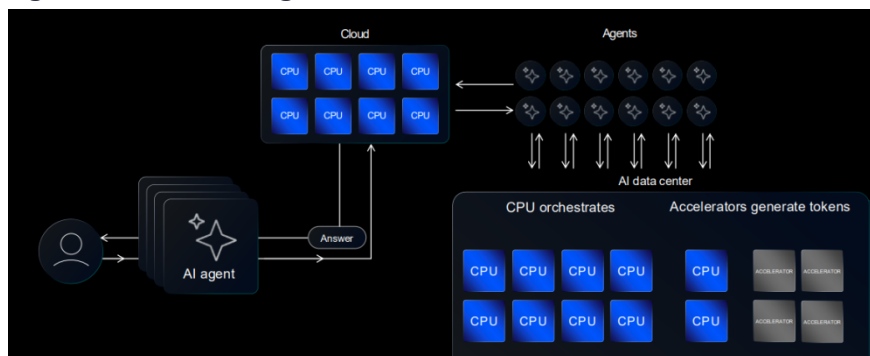
- We apply a SOTP valuation framework to each of Intel's reportable segments and to highlight our growth expectations for Intel Foundry. As such, our TP moves to \$95 from prior \$48 which was based on P/E valuation and 37X C27 EPS.
- We value Intel's DCAI business at \$49, we believe this segment could grow 32% YoY in 2026, 14% YoY in 2027, and 4% YoY in 2028. While we believe AMD will likely continue to gain server CPU share, we believe a 27X multiple is appropriate given the growth rate of the server CPU TAM and Intel's growing ASIC business.
- We believe CCG will likely decline 8% YoY in 2026, grow 1% YoY in 2027, and grow 3% in 2028. We are using a 15X multiple to value this business.
- For Intel Foundry, we assume the Terafab announcement could be a \$60 billion opportunity over 5 years. We expect this business to scale first with advanced packaging and later with external foundry revenue. We apply a 20X multiple to this business (based on TSMC's trading range) given our expectations of high growth where we model external foundry revenue to grow 66% YoY in 2027 and 131% in 2028.

- Two weeks ago, Intel traded up on the [social media announcement](#) that it was joining Elon Musk's Terafab project. The project is expected to involve \$20-\$25 billion in capex and will be located outside of Austin, Texas. The project aims to produce more than one terawatt of AI compute capacity per year. We believe Intel will serve as the foundry partner for some of Elon Musk's products, which includes humanoid robotics, AI data centers, and automotive chips such as Dojo. While we await more details, we believe this announcement lends credence to Intel building a successful foundry business. Amid increasing shortages across the foundry industry and the US government's support of Intel, we believe Intel has a unique window of opportunity to attract foundry wafer customers. We believe that 18A manufacturing is tracking better and the company expects customers to make decisions on 14A in 2H26/1H27. We are more constructive on Intel as we believe Lip Bu has right sized the company amid stabilizing capex. We view this announcement as positive for semi caps near term as well.

What's Driving Structural Growth in CPU Demand?

As highlighted in our 1Q26 semis preview (see [note](#)), CPUs are becoming increasingly important in agentic AI. GPUs have traditionally dominated AI workloads requiring large-scale parallel computation, with CPUs playing a supporting role in memory management. However, with the emergence of agentic AI, CPUs regain growth. CPUs can handle the orchestration, tool-calling, and evaluation steps that define agentic workflows. According to TrendForce, CPU: GPU unit ratios are expected to shift from 1:4-1:8 towards 1:1-1:2 in agentic AI deployments.

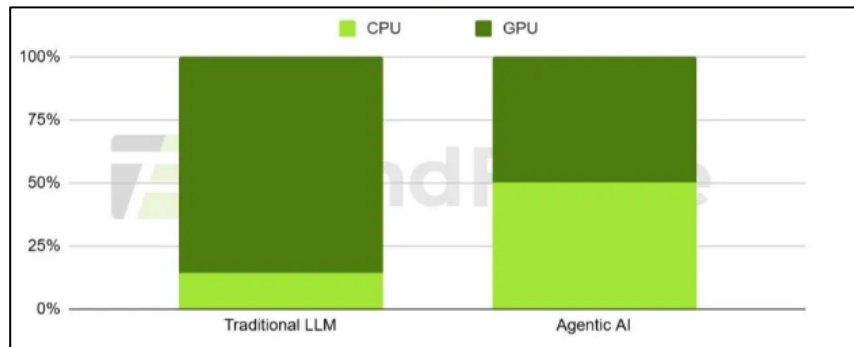
Figure 4. More CPUs in Agentic AI



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Source: Citi Research, Arm

Figure 5. Traditional LLMs vs Agentic AI



Source: TrendForce

Bull/Bear: Intel Corp (INTC.O)

US\$ **110.00**



▲ 65% Upside

US\$ **95.00**



▲ 42% Upside

US\$ **45.00**



▼ 33% Downside

US\$

114

95

76

57

38

19

Apr 25

Jul 25

Oct 25

Apr 26

Apr 27

23 Apr 26
US\$66.78

US\$110.00

US\$95.00

US\$45.00

Spread 97pp

Current Price and expected returns (upside/downside) as of 23 Apr 2026

BULL Assumptions



- Faster than expected foundry revenue ramp
- Gains share in PC and server CPUs

BASE Assumptions



- SOTP valuation of \$95
- Stabilizes share in PC CPUs

BEAR Assumptions



- 2026 PC unit contraction of >15% YoY
- Weaker than expected server CPU demand

Intel Corp

Company description

Intel is a semiconductor company that specializes in microprocessors and is the #1 supplier of microprocessors for desktop PCs, notebook PCs, and servers with approximately 60% total market share. Intel also has a foundry business. Based in Santa Clara, CA, Intel has roughly 83,200 employees worldwide. Intel derives approximately 90% of its total revenue and 90% of total profits from the PC and Datacenter segments. Intel is a vertically integrated device manufacturer (IDM) with front-end wafer fabrication facilities in Oregon, Arizona, New Mexico, China, Ireland, and Israel and back-end assembly and test operations in Malaysia, China, Costa Rica, and Vietnam.

Investment strategy

We are Buy rated on Intel shares given the AI-driven CPU cycle and we're more positive on Intel foundry given better execution by Intel management.

Valuation

We value INTC based on our SOTP valuation, our price target is \$95.

Risks

PC end-market: Intel derives roughly 90% of sales from the PC and server segments, which are highly dependent on IT spending. Therefore, any major uptick/downtick in IT spending could result in upside/downside to our estimates and cause us to reassess our rating on INTC.

M&A: If Intel engages in a substantial accretive acquisition, it could result in upside to our estimates.

Competition: Intel competes directly with AMD in the microprocessor market. Consequently, any fluctuations in market share between Intel and AMD could result in risk to our estimates.

Customer risk: Intel's largest PC OEM customers collectively represent roughly 45% Intel's revenue. As a result, any major declines in orders from PC OEMs could have a negative effect on our estimates for Intel.

Macroeconomic: Intel's geographic exposure spans multiple geographies including the U.S., Europe, and Asia. As a result, any prolonged macroeconomic downturn/upturn could result in downside/upside to our estimates and rating.

If the impact from the above risks turns out to be greater/less than we anticipate, the shares could fail to achieve or could exceed our target price.

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Appendix A-1

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IMPORTANT DISCLOSURES

Intel Corp (INTC)

Ratings and Target Price History Fundamental Research

Analyst: Atif Malik



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	27-Apr-23 07:32:08	2	*29.50	29.86
2	17-Jul-23 07:11:15	2	*34.00	34.37
3	12-Jan-24 06:06:09	2	*47.50	47.12
4	15-Apr-24 06:04:21	2	*40.00	36.31

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
5	26-Apr-24 03:00:00	2	*35.00	31.88
6	02-Aug-24 08:05:49	2	*25.00	21.48
7	01-Nov-24 03:17:08	2	*22.00	23.20
8	21-Jan-25 03:00:00	2	*21.00	21.77

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
9	07-Jul-25 03:00:00	2	*24.00	22.00
10	19-Sep-25 02:10:39	*3	*29.00	29.58
11	15-Jan-26 07:24:43	*2	*50.00	48.32
12	23-Jan-26 01:48:19	2	*48.00	45.07

*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Intel Corp (INTC)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Atif Malik



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	17-Jul-23 03:11:15	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	34.37
2	15-Oct-23 12:07:05	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	35.97

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
3	15-Apr-24 02:04:21	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	36.31
4	25-Apr-24 23:00:00	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	35.11

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
5	17-Jul-25 23:00:00	Add STV	Upside	30 Days	22.80
6	24-Jul-25 23:00:00	Remove STV	Upside	30 Days	22.63

CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

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